



Rating: 9/10  
Developer:  
Gas Powered Games  
Publisher: THQ  
Distributor:  
E-Xpress Interactive  
E-mail:  
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Price: Rs 699/-

## SUPREME COMMANDER™

While every other title that comes out these days throws around the term “genre redefining” quite loosely on their boxes, Chris Taylor’s *Total Annihilation* literally created the 3D Real-time Strategy (RTS) genre long before *Blizzard* and *StarCraft* came along to steal their thunder. Ten years and a handful of RPGs later, Chris Taylor returns to the genre with *Supreme Commander*, a game that is, like its predecessor, years ahead of its time.

Set in the distant future, with three opposing factions, as usual, warring for control, *Supreme Commander* takes a radical yet fun turn by letting the three single-player campaigns stand alone, instead of using them to tell a single connected story, as in *StarCraft* or *Command & Conquer 3: Tiberium Wars*. But what really sets the game apart is its sheer scale, and a unique ability to use multiple monitors to manage your war-

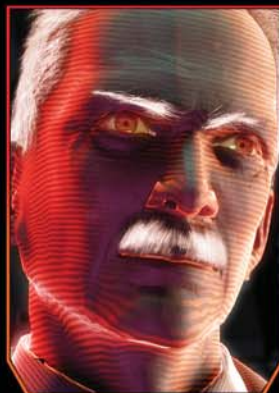
mongering. However, you are forced to constantly manage every little detail on the battlefield—juggling mass and energy resources, getting hapless engineers out of harm’s way, and repelling the huge armada that decided to wreak havoc on your sea units. *Supreme Commander* is one game where you cannot expect your missions to start and end in a five-minute Blitzkrieg, à la *Tiberium Wars*.

For such a complex game, *Supreme Commander* manages to provide excellent controls that allow you to queue up multiple tasks for units, direct them along complex routes to their destinations and set up complicated attack manoeuvres, all with a few mouse clicks and the omnipotent Shift key. Unfortunately for you, however, the enemy AI can and does the same and more often than not, you will suddenly find yourself being attacked on every front by hundreds of artillery units that soften

your base up for the rampaging Experimental Unit to come and finish you off.

The sheer scale of the game, however, does take its toll on system performance, and playing the game at the highest settings can bring frame rates down to a pathetic crawl if you zoom into the battlefield in the middle of a serious firefight. This is the only RTS that has managed to bring an Intel Core 2 Duo / 8800 GTS system to its knees at the highest settings, and most players would have to tone down the quality and split the screen in half in order to play properly. But if you are one of those with pockets deep enough to afford two widescreen monitors and a high-end Core 2 Duo / DX10 SLI powerhouse, there’s no better strategy game than this one. For the financially and tactically challenged, however, there’s always *Tiberium Wars*.

Krishnan Rajagopal



### DIGIT'S GAMING PC

XFx GeForce 8800GTX,  
Intel Core 2 Duo E6600,  
4 GB RAM, Windows  
Vista Ultimate x64, WD  
250 GB (x2) - RAID 0